

Ready to breed

When a female European mantis is ready to breed, she releases chemicals called pheromones into the air to attract a male.

Praying mantis

Mantises are deadly predators, snatching prey with their spine-clad legs and shredding it with their jaws. These insects can also be a danger to each other. Many female praying mantises, including this European mantis, eat the male after mating. The nutrients from the male's body help the female produce more eggs.

Easy does it

A male arrives and cautiously approaches the female. He positions himself behind her, to stop her from attacking him before they mate.

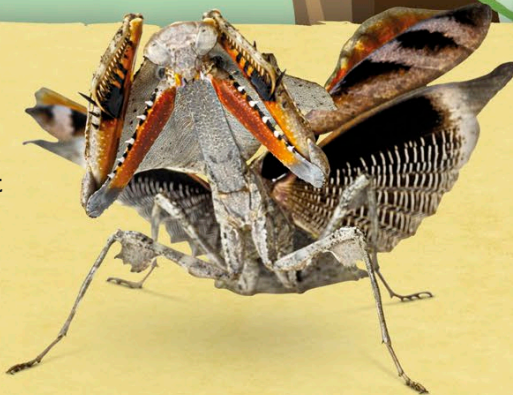
Devouring dad

After, or even during mating, the female sometimes decides to eat her male partner. She first bites off his head and then devours the rest of his body.

Hold tight!

The male leaps onto the female's back. After stroking her with his antennae to calm her down, the pair mate.

Scary display When threatened, many mantis species stand tall, spread their forelegs, and fan out their wings to make themselves look larger and more fearsome. This is enough to make some predators back off.



No boys allowed

Brunner's stick mantis is an all-female species, so there are no males to be eaten! The young are tiny clones (copies) of their mother. This kind of breeding is called parthenogenesis.

